Defining your brand as an artist...

Who you are, how you connect, and what you want people to feel.

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Defining the What, Why and How.

- What is your brand as an artist?
- Why does it matter?
- And, how do you **COMMUNICATE** it.

Who you are, how you connect, and what you want people to feel.

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What?

Understanding what a brand means - to your consumers...

Who you are, how you connect, and what you want people to feel.

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Branding

A brand is the sum of all expressions by which an entity (person, organization, company, business unit, city, nation, etc.) intends to be recognized.

https://interbrand.com/london/thinking/what-is-a-brand/

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Branding

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https://interbrand.com/london/thinking/what-is-a-brand/

Well, yes, it is, but that’s not the whole story....

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"A brand is a persons gut feeling about a product, service, or org."

–Marty Neumeier



Who you are, how you connect, and what you want people to feel.

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That’s more like it.

As Marty writes in ‘The Brand Flip’ (slightly amended!)

“Your brand is a continuing story told by both you, the artist and your fans. Every brand is a running narrative, a story-in-progress whose hero is the customer.”

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A brand is simply how a business is perceived in the mind of someone who has experienced it in some way. These experiences are known as **brand touchpoints**.

Brand touchpoints could be an online review, word-of-mouth referral from a friend, magazine article, piece of packaging, or a mention on social media.

Branding is the process of controlling how your business is seen and understood. **It's all about defining how you would like customers to think and feel about your brand.**

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Every time someone encounters you, they are forming an impression.

- Your song
- Your live show
- Your Instagram
- Your TikTok
- Your artwork
- Your clothes
- Your interviews
- Your bio
- Your music video
- The way you speak to people
- The way you interact with fans
- The people you collaborate with

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What do all of those things say about you?

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Why?

A reason to believe...

Who you are, how you connect, and what you want people to feel.

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Making an emotional connection with your target audience

Who you are, how you connect, and what you want people to feel.

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Why do some brands stay with us?

What is it about their personality, values etc. that we relate to, connect with, want to be part of...

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What kind of personality does this brand have?

Bold
Playful
Rebellious
Inspirational
Mysterious
Warm
Adventurous
Clever
Provocative
Inclusive
Elegant
Fearless
Curious
Nurturing
Optimistic
Serious

Choose 3...

Who you are, how you connect, and what you want people to feel.



Branding



Who you are, how you connect, and what you want people to feel.

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What kind of personality does this brand have?



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Optimistic
Serious

Choose 3...

©

What does the company believe in?

> to enable creative expression — and inspire youth culture —by celebrating and encouraging the Off the Wall attitude that comes from expressing your true self.
>
> Vans.com

Vision	Designed for the creative pursuit of being you.
Core Values	Connectedness, determination, inclusivity, expressive, and fun**.**

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Choose 3...



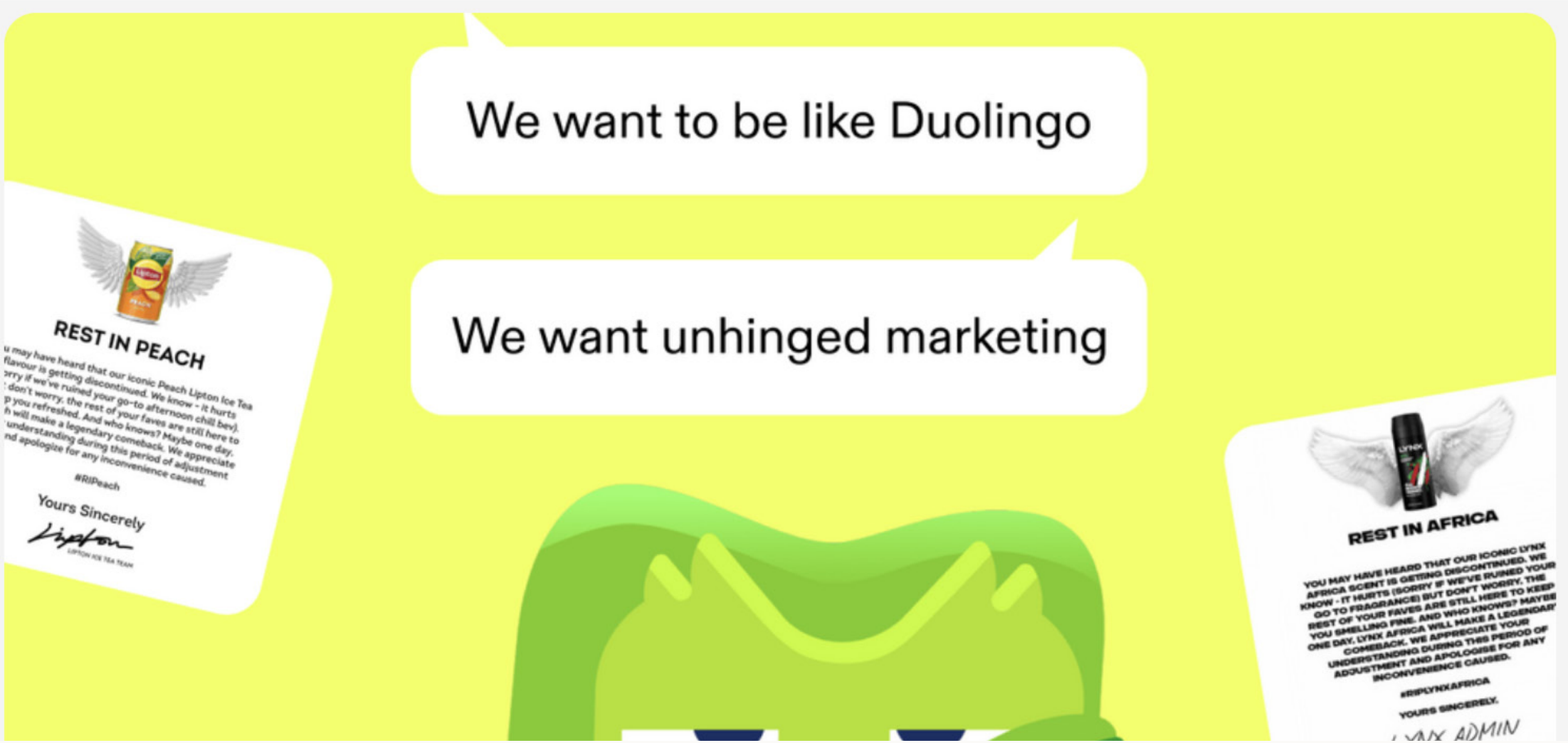
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Choose 3...



Branding



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So?

Why do some brands stay with us?

Keep these things in mind:

What makes a brand memorable?
It’s rarely just what they sell.

It’s more than a product
It’s how brands create feelings, identities and connections.

Selling more than the product
What are they really asking us to buy?

What are they really selling?
Look beyond the product.

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People don’t just connect with what you make. They connect with what it says about them.

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Why do people follow an artist?

It’s not just because they like the music.

“They sound like me.”

“They understand me.”

“They say something I can’t articulate.”

“They make me feel something.”

“I want to be like them.”

“I want to belong to this world.”

“They represent something I believe in.”

“They’re exciting / funny / beautiful / strange / challenging.”

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How?

Tell your story...

Who you are, how you connect, and what you want people to feel.

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Branding

Defining your identity and telling your story

Who you are, how you connect, and what you want people to feel.

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By using brand archetypes.

Who you are, how you connect, and what you want people to feel.

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One of the tools you can use for defining your brand is Brand Archetypes. Carl Jung developed a set of 12 personality types that he thought were personalities every human subconsciously knew of or modeled themselves after.

He called them the: The Innocent, Explorer, Sage, Hero, Outlaw, Magician, Everyman, Lover, Jester, Caregiver, Creator, and Ruler.

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Brand Archetypes

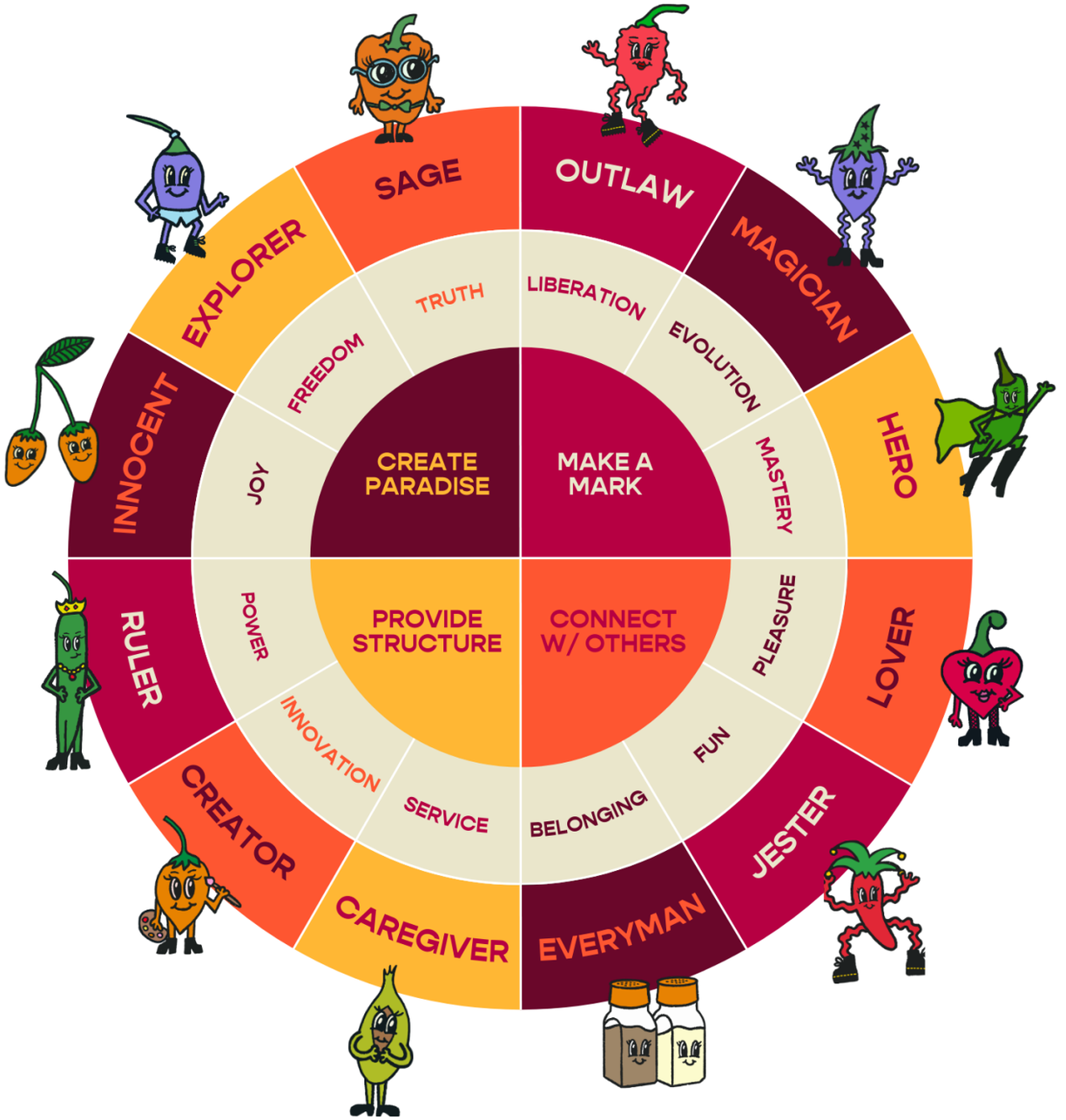
Brand archetypes are a useful tool for artists when they are trying to articulate, or differentiate, their brand's personality. They have been an incredibly potent weapon for many of the world's leading brands.The first step is to understand the character of each of the 12 main archetypes... and then identify which archetype best suits your brand.

You may need more than one.

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The 12 Brand Archetypes:

The Innocent
Explorer
Sage
Hero
Outlaw
Magician
Everyman
Lover
Jester
Caregiver
Creator
Ruler



Who you are, how you connect, and what you want people to feel.

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How do you see your brand/ yourself?

If your music is what you make, your brand is how people experience and interpret you, then your archetypes help define the character behind it.

They help you ask:
How do I want people to experience me?

Do I want to be:

- the one who challenges?
- the one who inspires?
- the one who makes people laugh?
- the one who makes people feel understood?
- the one who takes people somewhere else?
- the one who says what other people are thinking?
- the one who creates something completely new?

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Kendrick Lamar



SAGE
I want you to think.
Supported by OUTLAW
I want to challenge what you accept.
Elevated by CREATOR
I'll build a world that makes you experience it.

Core
The Sage

His work is fundamentally about questioning, examining and making sense of the world — society, race, identity, morality, fame, masculinity, personal responsibility.

He's asking questions rather than simply giving the audience an experience.

There's a strong sense of: *"Let's look more closely at this."*

Supported by
The Outlaw

But Kendrick doesn't occupy the Sage position quietly.

He challenges systems, conventions and expectations. His music can be confrontational and politically and culturally disruptive.

The Outlaw gives the Sage edge.

Elevated by
The Creator

His storytelling, production, visual language, characters and conceptual albums turn those ideas into something much bigger than commentary.

He's not simply telling us what he thinks. He's constructing narratives and experiences around those ideas.

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Billie Eilish



THE OUTLAW
I challenge the expected.
Supported by MAGICIAN
I create a world you haven't experienced.
Elevated by CREATOR
I make it distinctly mine.

Core
The Outlaw

Billie has consistently challenged expectations around what a young female pop artist should look and sound like.

Her brand rejects: conventional ideas of glamour polished pop-star femininity expectations around how an artist should behave musical conventions

There's a sense of "I'll do it my way."

Supported by
The Magician

There's also a strong element of transformation and creating an alternative world.

Her visuals, music videos, styling and performances often feel slightly surreal, strange or unsettling.
She isn't simply presenting herself, she's creating an atmosphere and pulling the audience into it.

Elevated by
The Creator

The creative control is important. Billie and Finneas have built a very coherent musical and visual world around the work.

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What about you?



CORE

XXX

SUPPORTED BY

XXX

ELEVATED BY

XXX

Core
?

The fundamental character of my artist brand.

Supported by
?

The quality that strengthens or gives dimension to it.

Elevated by
?

The quality I want to grow into or become better known for.

Who you are, how you connect, and what you want people to feel.

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The Magician

As a brand archetype, Magicians make dreams come true and – hey presto – make problems disappear. They do things, both big and small, that amaze and transform.

Intelligent and knowledgeable, magicians have access to secret information, the dissemination of which adds value to customers and positions the brand as problem-solving or wish-fulfilling transformers.

Brand archetype gift: Turning problems into solutions, making dreams come true.

Brand archetype examples: Disney, Dyson, TUI.



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The Creator

The Creator has a vision, a way they feel the world should be, and they want to create an enduring product that turns that vision into reality.

Creators crave authenticity, innovation and freedom of expression to make sense of the world around them, and use creativity and technology to enable creativity in others.

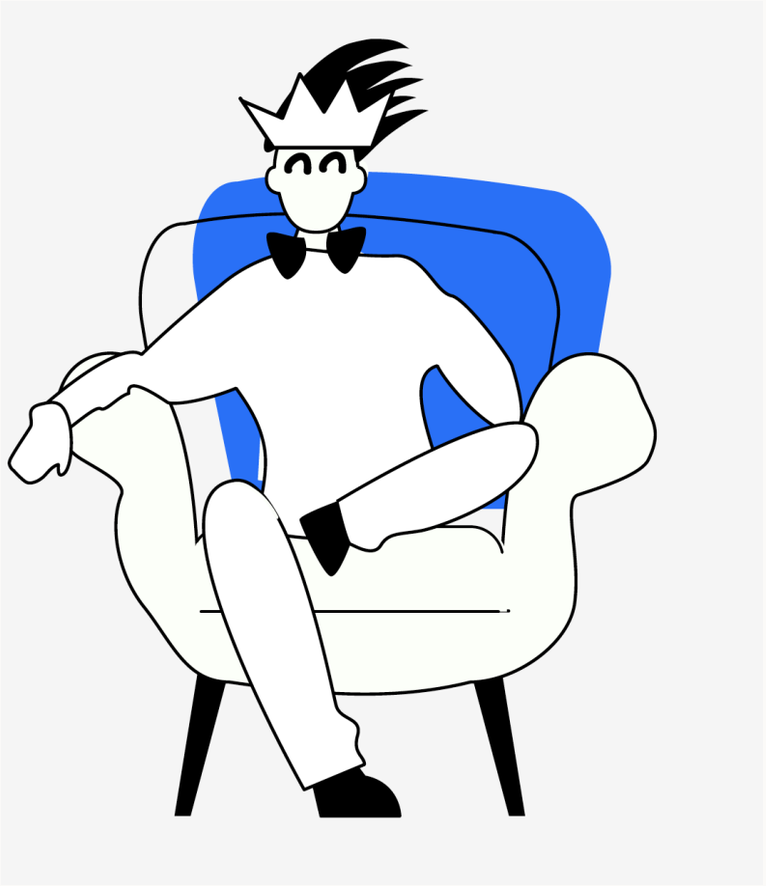
Brand archetype gift: Inspiring creativity, creating an authentic brand story, fusing technology and artistry.

Brand archetype examples: Adobe, GoPro, Apple.



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The Ruler



The Ruler seeks to eliminate uncertainty by taking control. They like to follow rules but, even better, they like to make them. (Rulers need followers, after all.)

Rulers believe in playing the game properly and create stable, respected brands to suit. They also expect the same propriety from others, which is why politicians naturally fall into this category (and often fail at it, too...).

Sometimes their confidence extends into arrogance and so Ruler brand archetypes need to be careful not to appear despotic, thus leaving the door open to pretenders to steal their throne.

Brand archetype gift: Fostering stability and trust, creating high-quality products that lead the way.

Brand archetype examples: Rolls Royce, Microsoft, American Express.

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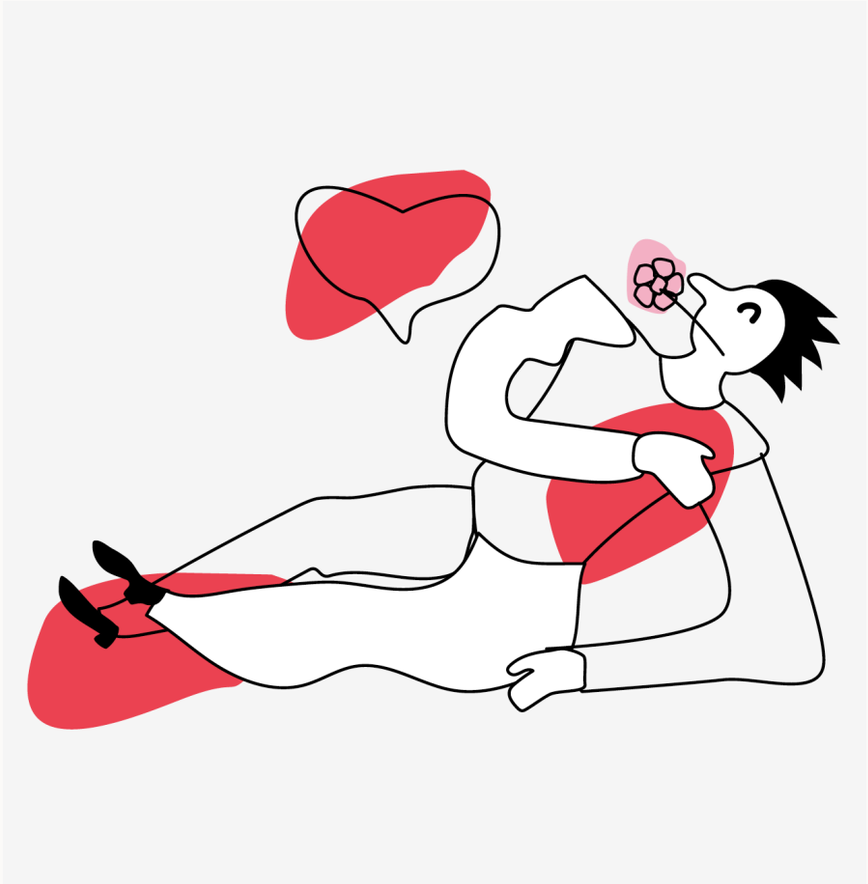
The Lover

Who says romance is dead? Not the Lover, that's for sure, who inspires closer relationships through sensuousness and seductiveness.

But it's not all about romance; the types of relationships the Lover fosters are also spiritual, familial, companionable. For Lover brand archetypes, the focus is on improving connections with the people and things that really matter.

Brand archetype gift: Connecting people emotionally, providing sensuous experiences, making people – and life – more special.

Brand archetype examples: Victoria's Secret, Häagen-Dazs, Cesar.



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The Caregiver

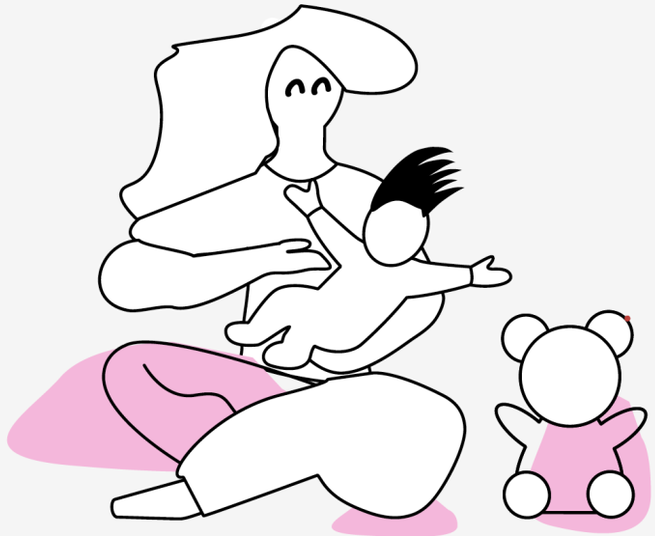
Caregivers live to give. They're motivated by compassion and want to make people feel secure and nurtured.

As defenders of the less fortunate, Caregivers are found in teaching, nursing and charities, but also appear as gardeners, cleaners and in restorative jobs, such as mending clothes and refurbishing.

Because they're altruistically rather than financially motivated, Caregivers are considered trustworthy. Brands such as Heinz and Johnson & Johnson have tapped into the Caregiver brand archetype, couching their products in a quasi-medicinal, nurturing way.

Brand archetype gift: Making people feel safe, fostering trust, generating public support for the socially-minded service they provide

Brand archetype examples: NSPCC, NHS, Heinz.



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The Jester

The class clown, the office joker – we've all known one in our time. And, crucially, we all remember them. They want to have fun, to lighten the mood by connecting with their inner child. And, just like most children, they're not too fond of obeying rules.

Jesters think outside the box because they've never spent their lives living in it – which makes them great innovators.

On the face of it, Jesters live for the moment, but at a deeper level, they understand that life is fleeting and needs to be filled with laughter whenever possible.

Brand archetype gift: Helping people see the lighter side of life, spreading creativity through joy.

Brand archetype examples: Cadbury's, Paddy Power, Budweiser



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The Sage

The Sage believes that the truth will set you free. They are driven by the desire for truth and knowledge and use them to make the world a better place by sharing their findings.

Sage archetypes are rigorous researchers and reject misleading messaging and ignorance. They typically show higher levels of intelligence and social awareness.

As arbiters of information, they are often highly regarded as a trustworthy and intelligent source of information.

Brand archetype gift: Illuminating the world through knowledge-sharing, earning respect through intellectualism.

Brand archetype examples: TED, The Economist, Discovery Channel.



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The Explorer

Explorers are independent thinkers, forging new paths to find purpose in life – and to change it in the process. They are often individualistic in outlook but their clear, strong vision inspires others to join them.

Explorers seek freedom and joy through discovery, often eschewing rules and conformism as a result. This means they're defined more by their trailblazing philosophy than by the industry in which they work, so that an Explorer brand archetype may be defined by decentralising and democratising its internal structures.

Brand archetype gift: Inspiring change through innovative vision and force of personality.

Brand archetype examples: NASA, Patagonia, The Body Shop.



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The Rebel

Unlike the Explorer, who disregards rules as a by-product of their behaviour, the Rebel actively rips up the rulebook.

Rebels see opportunity in dismantling existing paradigms as a way to create something newer, better and often cheaper. They position themselves as free-thinking outlaws – a romanticised and intoxicating social archetype.

The Rebel brand archetype seeks to undermine the status quo so that people question it, search for better alternatives and – ta-dah – turn to them in the process.

Of all archetypes, Rebels inspire the strongest brand loyalty as their countercultural message resonates beyond just the product and into their customers' lifestyles and philosophies.

Brand archetype gift: Disrupting existing structures, rock 'n' roll sex appeal, promoting brand loyalty.

Brand archetype examples: Harley Davidson, Diesel, Greenpeace.



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The Hero

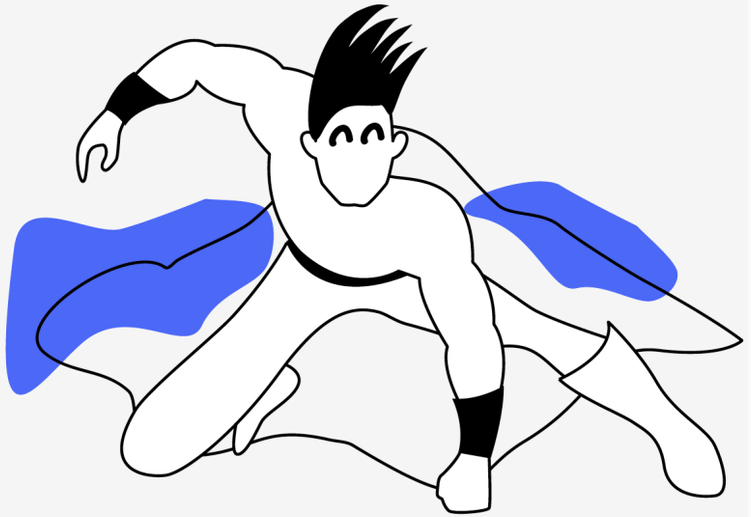
Just like their DC and Marvel spandex-clad counterparts, the Hero brand archetype rises to the challenge. They protect and inspire. They sell the power of self-belief and transformation.

The Hero turns a brand into a story of triumph over adversity. So that a company like Nike isn't seen as a seller of trainers but as a transformative device that helps people achieve their full potential.

There is a moralism to the Hero. They see their work as important and empowering and take great pride in the positive effect they feel they have on the world.

Brand archetype gift: Inspiring courage and achievement by overcoming adversity.

Brand archetype examples: Nike, Red Cross, FedEx.



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The Everyman

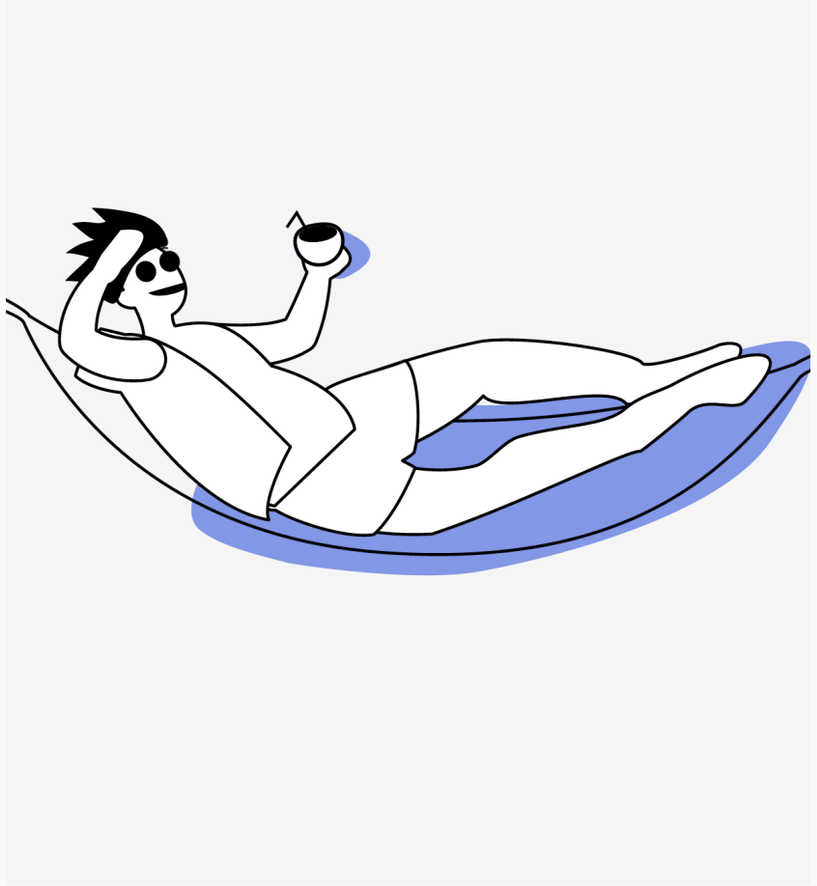
The Everyman is your salt-of-the-earth type: non-pretentious, relatable, wholesome, comfortable. The Everyman values hard work, common sense, reliability and authenticity.

They want to appeal to a mass market and so disregard the trappings of luxury. For the Everyman, practicality wins over pretence. Think Ford instead of Ferrari, Gap instead of Gucci.

Symbolically, the Everyman allies themselves to families and multiple cultures, appealing to those who sit below the luxury threshold and who, as the brand might describe it, better understand the value of money.

Brand archetype gift: Bringing safety, reliability, trust and comfort to a mass market.

Brand archetype examples: McCain, Tesco, Ford.



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The Innocent

The promise of the Innocent brand archetype is one of simplicity bordering on naivety. The Innocent looks at the world through the lens of a child, seeing wonder, fun and happiness at every turn, and hoping to pass that good feeling on through their work.

Not usually ones for innovation, Innocent brands rely instead on the simplicity of their product (organic food, baby soaps) or through childlike communications (Coca Cola).

Brand archetype gift: Spreading purity and joy in a cynical world.

Brand archetype examples: Coca Cola, Innocent (obviously), Johnson's.



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You

Tell your story...

Who you are, how you connect, and what you want people to feel.

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Using Brand Diamonds

The brand diamond is used to dimensionalise brands.

Based on the concept of a Character Diamond –
the values that shape the way a character thinks,
acts, and sees the world.

They have been primarily used by screenwriters when they are creating characters that they want people to fall in love with, but marketers have found them to be an excellent tool for branding as well.

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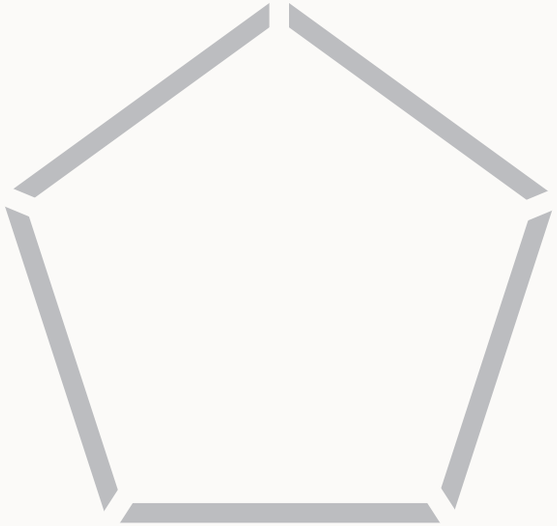
Branding

What is distinctive about your music?

Brand Diamond Exercise

Use this as a brainstorming session and refine.

What kind of artist do you want to become?



What matters to you?

How do you make people feel?

What is your personality?

Who you are, how you connect, and what you want people to feel.

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Define your artist's character

What do you want people to feel when they experience your work?

Choose 3 to 5 of these as a kick-starter...

Excited / understood / challenged / inspired / comforted / energised / curious / emotional / included / empowered / surprised / entertained / moved / free

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What do you want people to associate with you?

3 words...

What makes you different?

What would be missing if **you** weren't making this music?

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Your Archetypes?



CORE

XXX

SUPPORTED BY

XXX

ELEVATED BY

XXX

Core
?

The fundamental character of my artist brand.

Supported by
?

The quality that strengthens or gives dimension to it.

Elevated by
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Branding

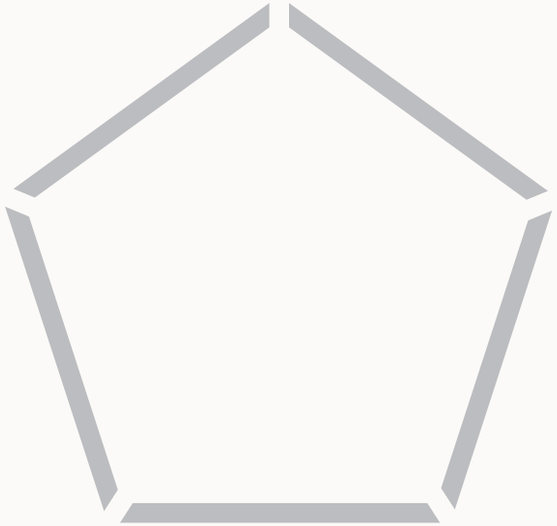
Tech Start-up
Example Only
First BD based on client's questionnaire feedback

Aims & Aspirations

- *Maximise our clients' understanding of and engagment with inclusion*
- *Create effective long-term solutions for inclusive business strategies*
- *Be an innovative, disruptive market leader*
- *Support organisational change through research and content generation*

Unique Attributes/POD

- *First to market - no marketplace out there*
- *None that connect learning to outcome*
- *Offers an accreditation to DEI Professionals*
- *Full stack DEI service*
- *Metric-based results*
- *Cusomisable products?*
- *Generally American products are very focused on trends, trend driven not fact driven*



Experience & Reason to Believe

- *An inclusive workforce makes business sense*
- *We enable businesses to achieve optimum inclusivity*
- *Our approach is evidence-based and time-saving*
- *We are focused on your business & its devpt.*
- *We streamline the process for your business*
- *Clear, non-jargon, non-preachy approach*

Personality/Founder Attributes

Brave
Willing to break down barriers
Disruptive
Pioneering
Proactive
Positive
Solution focused -
able to identify problems and come up with solutions

Value to client - Rational/Emotional

- *Measurable business benefits*
- *Holistic approach - full product bundle*
- *Learnings, happier workforce*
- *Compliance - able to support DEI action plans*
- *Track progress & results*
  Go in and see reviews, book seminars
- *Connected to metrics on the platform*
- *Hub for everything they need in DEI area*
- *Engaging content (Educational - clients)*

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So?

What do you actually DO with your brand?

Who you are, how you connect, and what you want people to feel.

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Your brand isn’t something you finish
and then put on Instagram.

It becomes a filter for your decisions.

When you’re:

- writing your bio
- choosing a photograph
- making a video
- planning a gig
- posting on social
- talking to a promoter
- releasing a song
- choosing collaborators
- designing merchandise
- doing an interview

Does this feel like me?

Does this reinforce what I want people to know about me?

Does this make the right people want to come closer?

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Know what you make.

Know what you stand for.

Know how you want people to feel.

Know who you're speaking to.

Then communicate it consistently.

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